

bottom of the skull**occipital bone**

Flat skull bone articulating with the parietal bone and atlas (first cervical vertebra), among others; it makes up the largest portion of the base of the skull.

foramen magnum

Opening in the occipital bone through which the medulla oblongata passes.

carotid canal

Opening in the temporal bone through which the internal carotid artery passes.

sphenoid bone

Bone located behind the nasal fossae; it articulates with all the cranial bones.

zygomatic process

Projection of the temporal bone that forms the upper edge of the cheek.

zygomatic bone

Bone forming the cheek pouch and the outer edge of the eye socket.

palatine bone

Bone spanning the width of the skull located behind the orbits.

mandible

Movable toothed bone forming the lower jaw; it is the only movable bone in the head and its articulation with the temporal bone allows the jaw to move.

